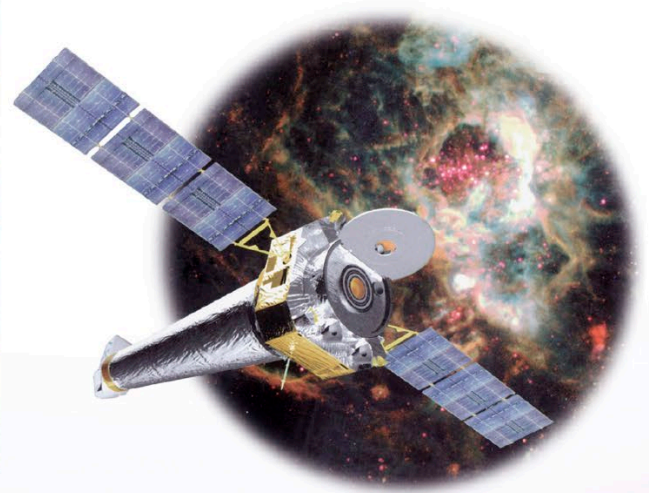




A better view

The Royal Greenwich Observatory moved its telescopes three times because pollution clouded their view. Originally in Greenwich, near London, England, the telescopes ended up in the Canary Islands, 2.3 km (1.4 miles) above sea level.



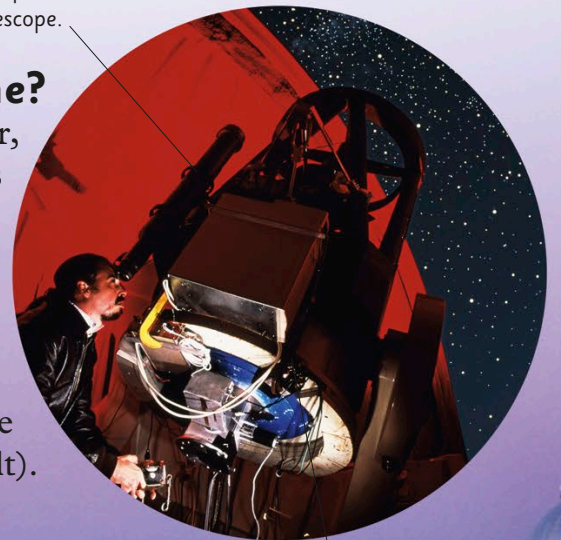
Space telescope

Scientists use the Chandra X-ray Observatory telescope to study black holes and exploding stars.

A "Finderscope" is used to line up the main telescope.

What's in a name?

A telescope with a lens or mirror, called an optical telescope, gathers more light than the human eye. Large telescopes use mirrors – the larger the mirror, the more it can see. Telescope projects are often given grand names – the Very Large Telescope, the European Extremely Large Telescope, and the Overwhelmingly Large Telescope (which is yet to be built).



Near to the twin Keck telescopes are the Canada-France-Hawaii Telescope and Gemini North telescope.

Large mirror inside

